



Propagator

The Monthly Newsletter of the South Orange County Amateur Radio Association

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General Meeting

NPM Center
Mar 16, 2026
6:30 PM
Norman P. Murray
Center
23492 Veterans
Way, Mission Viejo,
CA 92692

President's Message

SOARA is a club run for and by volunteers. There are members who give their time and special skills to run the business of the organization, known as the Board of Directors. A volunteer sets up and runs the SOARA Saturday program. We have volunteers doing Net Control for the weekly 2M/220/440 Net, the D-Star Net, the 40M Net and the 10M net. We have volunteers to coordinate Winter Field Day, Field Day, the Summer picnic and the Holiday dinner. There are others who help SOARA doing other tasks. If you are one of those who volunteer your time to help with these events, SOARA thanks you and I also want to express my appreciation for your assistance.

Field Day is where we see the largest group of members participating in one way or another. Unfortunately, for the other activities that SOARA sponsors, there are only a very small group of members doing most of the work to keep the club running. Recently, the members of SOARA passed a revised Constitution and Bylaws that, among other things, expanded the Board of Directors to 16 positions. The idea was to give more members an opportunity to join the Board and share in setting the direction of SOARA for the future. Most of the new positions do not have any specific job that must be done and the hope is that when new members join the Board in one of these 'At Large' positions and then, after getting to know how the organization operates, they will take on some task(s) that they are interested in doing. As voting members of the Board, they will also help manage the day to day affairs of the organization.

My reason for writing this is to ask each of you who are reading this to consider joining the SOARA Board. We really need your help. Depending on the task(s) you decide to take on, the time it might take could be only a few hours a month. You should plan to come to Board meetings, held monthly at present on the Monday after the General meeting, but you

need not attend every meeting once you get familiar with what needs to be done. The goal of adding the 'At-Large' Board positions is to get more help from members, while giving those volunteers a larger say in how SOARA is run.

Again, this need not be a big commitment of time. As the saying goes "Many hands make light work". We see this at Field Day and we want to spread the rest of the work out to the largest number of members possible.

If you think you might be interested in being an 'At-Large' Director or to fill the position of Membership Director or IT Director, please reach out to me, w6edt@soara.org or any other SOARA Board member. You can be appointed to any open position and you can also run for a Board position in the April election. SOARA NEEDS YOU!

It's also time to think about our Field Day operations. We made some changes last year that simplified the setup and operating of the event, including having prepared food brought in as opposed to cooking on site. We relocated some antennas to reduce interference. We did have some problems with the 40M/80M dipoles being suspended in the ball field, so we need to come up with a different plan for those bands..

I hope you are enjoying the warmer than usual weather and have been able to get out and have fun, perhaps even using your radio(s).

73,

Dale Tyler - W6EDT

Membership Meeting

SOARA Membership Meeting – Dipole Antennas

Join us for the SOARA monthly meeting on Monday, March. As usual, we will gather at 6:30 PM, and start the main presentation about 7:00.

Ray, AE6H, is going to share with us a presentation that was made to his radio club in Maine. The subject is Dipole Antennas.

We are not planning to add Zoom for this meeting, so please show up in person if you want to participate.

Hope to see you there.

73, Greg Unruh, WE4BY

SOARA Saturday Report

We were at the Murray center, 9am to noon. 11 Attendees: WA6ED Ed, N6PM Greg, K6NOV Ray, KF6QPC John, W6TRG Tom, KO6IYK Mike, AE6H Ray, KK6UMB Tom, W6CAG Claude, NY6I Charles, AD6OH Patti

Greg brought donuts. Thank you Greg! We started with \$15, Paid Greg \$21 for donuts, and we took in \$11. Balance \$5 for March. John KF6QPC took photos. Thank you John!

Ed, WA6ED demoing the 7" NanoVna. I brought a RF demo board made for the NanoVna. I accidentally toggled to S21, it needed to be S11. That was a big pain until I figured it out. Patti AD6OH brought a small SMA antenna. This allowed us to demo SWR over frequency ranges.



Ray operating his new Baofeng APRS radio. Ray demoed his radio on the screen and a bluetooth APRS app on his phone. Very cool for the price.



Link to SES schedule page on the SOARA.org website:

<https://www.soara.org/club-calendar/soara-saturdays>

Next month, 3/21/2026 at Murray Center, 9am to noon. Bring a ham radio related demo if you like. If anyone wants to bring a ham radio related presentation, please let me know details.

73,

Ed WA6ED

The Art of Erecting a Delta Loop Antenna Among Trees

Due to recent storms involving high winds, my Delta Loop antenna found itself sprawled on the ground and partially hanging from the rooftop of my home..... Thanks to the kind efforts of Dale, W6EDT (our club President), my XYL Cher (K6CHR) and whatever assistance I (your humble net controller for the Sunday morning 40 meter Net) was able to render, we succeeded in restoring the antenna to a new place of honor, away, at least on one side, from the

non-forgiving dancing of the trees in the winds!



One corner of the antenna is still located 40' high in a eucalyptus tree on one side of the back of the property. The newly revised side of the antenna is attached to a telescoping fiberglass mast located at the other side of the back of the property. The mast is from Max-Gain Systems, Inc., <http://mgs4u.com>. Model MK-8-HD, Black Stealth. It is a 50' telescoping fiberglass mast, UV resistance incorporated into the manufacture of the mast. For strength, the 50' mast has been set at 35' with 20" overlap at each section. This antenna uses Telescoping Tube clamps to lock each section in place. For additional security, hose clamps were added at each section.

The mast is stabilized in a sleeve of a custom one-off steel frame, four feet from ground level. The frame is securely pressure-locked onto a ~18x18" square 4' slump stone column at the back corner of the property. The base of the mast is in a sleeve which is secured in a concrete block further strengthened and adding weight using Quikrete filler. Thus, allowing for superior stability against lateral forces that may occur with the mast. No guying was used in this install.

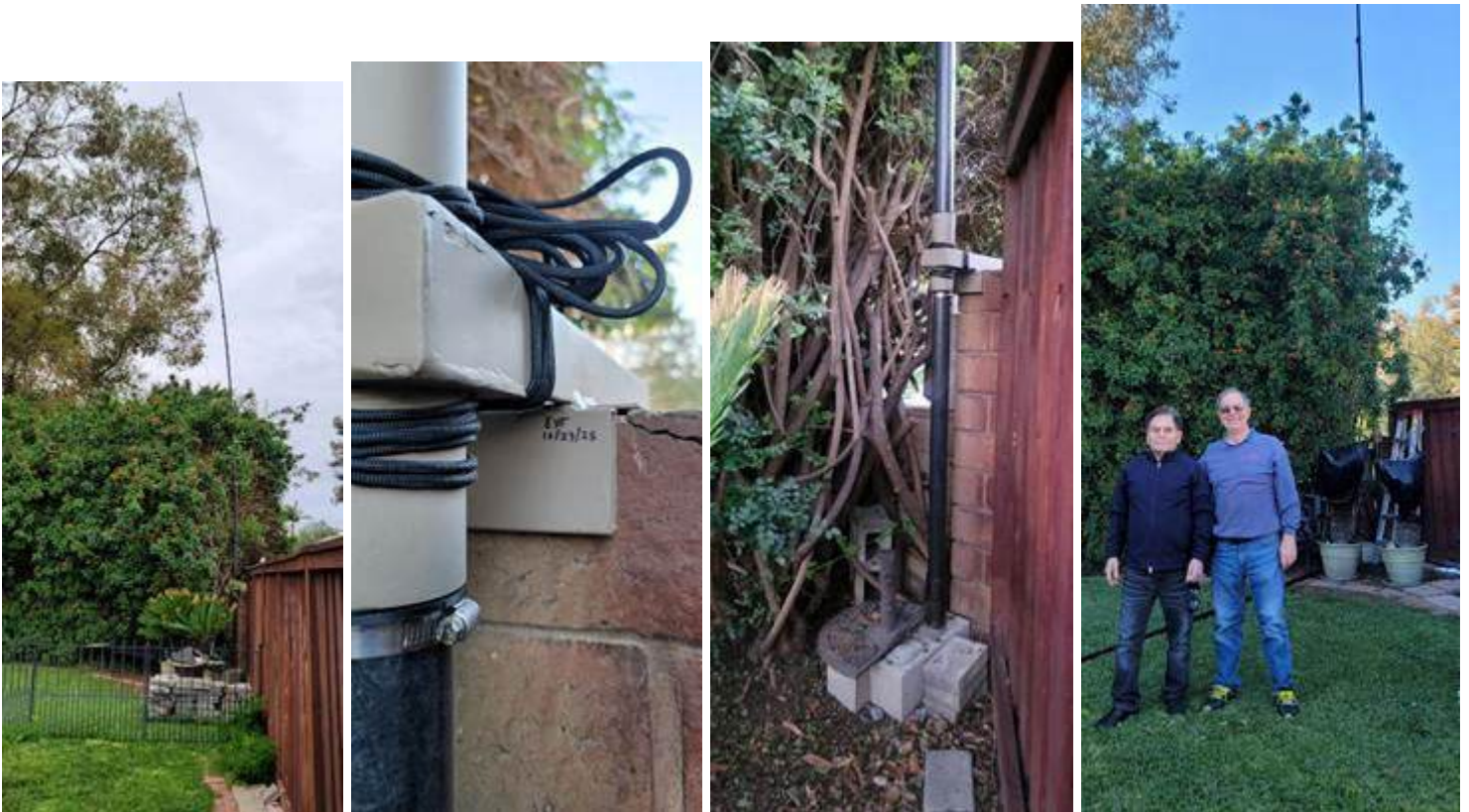
The antenna wire is gray 16AWG PTFE silver tinned avionics wire, stranded. The length of wire used for the antenna is 210'. The 250' wire spool was purchased from Remington Industries, www.remintonindustries.com. Both ends of the antenna wire terminate at a 4' chimney mast secured by chimney straps. The termination point is a WA1FFL LADDER-LOC® antenna device purchased from WA1FFL James Hagerty, j.hagerty@att.net. The LADDER_LOC® was chosen because the platform provides built-in strain relief. 450-ohm #18-gauge solid copper-clad steel wire (rectangular-windowed type)

The 50' length of Ladder-line runs along the roof from the chimney to the back peak of the house. The Ladder-line connects to a 9:1 Balun attached to the soffit at the roof peak. The balun is rated at 5kw, Palamar Engineers, Model # CB-9-5000TS, Palomar-engineers.com

Coax cable, LMR-400-UF Low Loss Flexible 50 ohm Coax Cable from HRO, runs from the balun through the attic to the shack. The radio setup is available for view on WA6LDI page at QRZ.com.

Additional hardware used for this setup are 1 1/2" stainless steel pulleys, 3/16" Dacron rope, 5' ground rod, 14AWG ground wire and 3D printed bushings and antenna cap.

A 3 1/2' pvc mast installed on the fascia supports midway the long run of antenna wire from the chimney to the 35' mast. This support mast reduces the flex effect of the 35' mast.



Phil Lonzello, WA6LDI

SOARA Wants You!

Director of Marketing & Social Media

With the recent passage of the By-Laws update, several new positions have opened on the Board of Directors. One of those positions is Director of Marketing & Social Media — a great opportunity for someone who wants to help promote and grow our club.

This role focuses on managing SOARA's social media presence and exploring new ways to increase awareness of the club. It does not require event planning (unless you'd like to get involved in that as well).

We currently maintain accounts on Facebook, X, and BlueSky, and we're looking to expand even further. As of 2026, we also have a YouTube channel featuring recordings of our weekly nets (HF nets when available) and videos from SOARA Saturdays.

The Director of Marketing & Social Media will:

- Post engaging updates about SOARA activities, nets, events, and club news
- Help highlight member achievements and special activities
- Identify new platforms or outreach opportunities
- Strengthen SOARA's visibility in the amateur radio community

In addition to shaping the club's public presence, this position includes a seat on the Board — meaning you'll have a vote and a voice in how the club operates.

If you're looking for a way to contribute that doesn't require a major time commitment or prior experience, this is a fantastic opportunity to make a real impact.

Interested? Please contact **board@soara.org** or speak with any current Board member at the next monthly meeting.

Charles, NY6I

SOARA - Statement of Cash Income & Expenses **October 1, 2025 Through February 28, 2026**

SOARA - Statement of Cash Income & Expenses			
October 2025 Through February 2026			
Five Months:	February	February	Increase
	<u>2026</u>	<u>2025</u>	<u>(Decrease)</u>
Cash Income:			
Memberships	6,151	9,155	(3,004)
Other & Interest	<u>1,935</u>	<u>1,654</u>	<u>281</u>
Total Cash Income	<u>8,086</u>	<u>10,809</u>	<u>(2,723)</u>
Cash Expenses:			
Repeaters including site			
rental, utilities & insurance	2,006	3,163	(1,157)
Member Activities	2,833	2,174	659
Other expenses	<u>2,434</u>	<u>982</u>	<u>1,452</u>
Total Cash Expenses	<u>7,274</u>	<u>6,319</u>	<u>955</u>
Cash Net Income	812	4,490	(3,678)
Beginning Cash-October 1	<u>28,179</u>	<u>25,745</u>	<u>2,434</u>
Ending Cash- February 28	28,991	30,235	(1,244)
Note: If any member has questions about the financials, please contact the Treasurer or any Board member.			

Ron Mosher - KOPGE
SOARA Treasurer

Calendars

Upcoming SOARA Events

Dates are subject to change. Check the SOARA Web Site (<http://www.soara.org>) to verify locations and times

This Month...

- | | |
|----------------------|--|
| March 14 9 AM | - Technician Review Session, Murray Center |
| March 16 6:00 PM | - HAM Radio License Exams, Murray Center |
| March 16 6:30 PM | - General Meeting, Murray Center |
| March 21 9 AM – Noon | - SOARA Elmer Saturday, Murray Center |
| March 23 7:00 PM | - Board Meeting, Murray Center |

Month...

- | | |
|----------------------|--|
| April 18 9 AM – Noon | - SOARA Elmer Saturday, Murray Center |
| April 20 6:00 PM | - HAM Radio License Exams, Murray Center |
| April 20 6:30 PM | - General Meeting, Murray Center |
| April 27 7:00 PM | - Board Meeting, Murray Center |

SOARA Information

SOARA meets at the Norman P. Murray Center, 24932 Veterans Way, Mission Viejo, CA on the third Monday of every month at 7:00 PM. For the months of January and February the third Monday is a holiday and the meeting is held on the fourth Monday.

License Exams: Amateur License Exams are given prior to SOARA meetings, except June. Exams are at 6pm. Prior registration is not required and walk-in applicants are welcome. For June, exams are held at Field Day. For further information, email Steve Kuver, K6UVR, at k6uvr@soara.org.

SOARA Library: SOARA has many amateur radio related books such as hand books, books about electrical theory, etc. available to lend out to club members. Contact library@soara.org for more info.

Web Site: SOARA maintains a web site with current club information. The URL is: <http://www.soara.org/>

Repeaters: The Laguna Beach, San Clemente, and Trabuco repeaters are open. The Santiago Peak repeaters are closed. For details or questions on the repeaters contact the repeater director, or repeater@soara.org.

2m	— 147.645 — (110.9)	Laguna Beach
2m	— 146.025 + (110.9)	San Clemente
2m	— 145.240 — (110.9)	Trabuco
D-STAR 2m	— 146.115 + (K6SOA C)	Laguna Beach
220	— 224.100 — (110.9)	Laguna Beach
220	— 224.640 — (pvt)	Santiago Peak. (C)
440	— 445.660 — (110.9)	Laguna Beach
D-STAR 440	— 445.705 — (K6SOA B)	Laguna Beach
440	— 447.180 — (pvt)	Santiago Peak. (C)
D-STAR 1.2G	1282.600 — (K6SOA A)	Laguna Beach

Nets:

- ☐ 40 meter HF (7.200 MHz +/- , Sundays @ 8 AM
- ☐ 10 meter HF (Technicians Welcome) (28.415 +/-) Sundays @ 9 AM
- ☐ General Membership Net - UHF/VHF (447.180, 147.645 & 224.640): Tuesdays @ 8 PM
- ☐ D-STAR (146.115 C module): Wednesdays @ 8 PM
- ☐ Tech Net - 147.645, 224.640, 447.180: Saturdays @ 9 AM
- ☐ California Rescue Communications (Gordo Net) HF (7.250 MHz +/- for QRM): Weekdays @ 8:30AM
- ☐ MVRACES – 447.180: Tuesdays @ 7PM
- ☐ Tri-Cities RACES – 146.025: Wednesdays @ 8 PM
- ☐ LNACS – 147.645: Thursdays @ 7 PM
- ☐ OC Parks Fire Watch – 447.180: Thursdays @ 8 PM

SOARA OFFICERS

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V.P.: Greg Unruh , WE4BY
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SOARA DIRECTORS

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SOARA APPOINTMENTS

Past President: Ray Hutchinson, , AE6H
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Raffle: Open

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